

● Ready to Rank
DIGITAL MARKETING
GOOGLE ADS · PERFORMANCE REPORT

Vic. Haulage Co. Campaign Update

Month-on-month performance across April–August 2026. A quieter month than July's record — spend came down, and lead volume with it — but the account was more efficient on every engagement measure.

Prepared by Ready to Rank

Reporting period Apr – Aug 2026 · AUD

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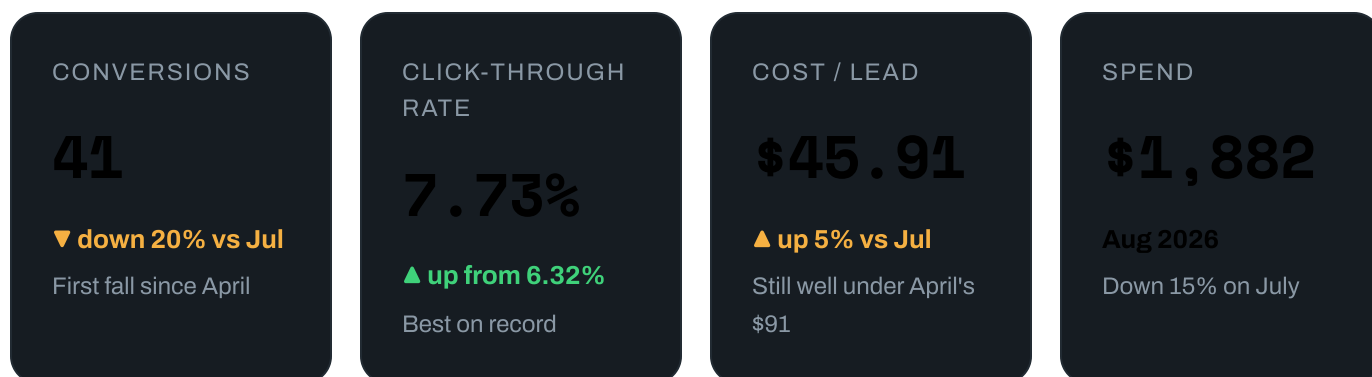
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Performance snapshot

August 2026 — across both active search campaigns. Leads eased back from July's record as spend was reduced, but the quality of the traffic improved again.



The headline: **we spent 15% less and got 20% fewer leads**. Cost per lead rose only slightly, from \$43.52 to \$45.91 — so the account didn't get less efficient so much as it got *smaller*. Two things drove that: the daily budget came down partway through the month, and the ads were switched off entirely on seven of the month's thirty-one days.

Underneath the smaller numbers, the campaign actually sharpened. Click-through rate hit **7.73%** and conversion rate **34.5%** — both the best figures the account has recorded.

Month-on-month breakdown

April's high impressions came from a Performance Max campaign since paused. Since then the account has run as focused search — fewer impressions, better people clicking. August is the first month since April in which lead volume has gone backwards.

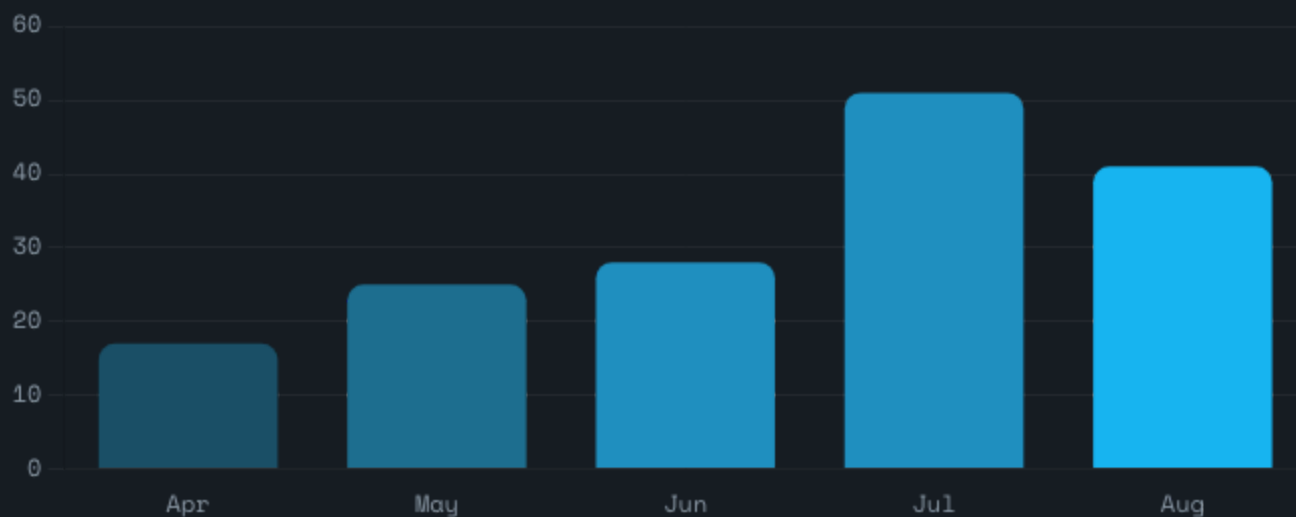
Metric	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG
Impressions	66,319	12,907	2,074	2,391	1,531
Clicks	386	339	132	151	111
Conversions	17	25	28	51	49
Conversion rate	4.4%	7.4%	21.2%	33.8%	34.5%
CTR	0.58%	2.63%	6.36%	6.32%	7.73%
Avg. CPC	\$4.03	\$3.20	\$11.57	\$14.70	\$15.88
Cost	\$1,553.92	\$1,083.59	\$1,527.69	\$2,219.63	\$1,882.11
Cost / conversion	\$91.41	\$43.34	\$54.56	\$43.52	\$45.98

July's figures are now final and read slightly higher than last month's report (51 conversions rather than 49, \$2,219.63 spend rather than \$2,184.32). That report was produced on 31 July before the month had closed; late-attributed conversions have since landed. August's figures were pulled on the final day of the month and will firm up the same way.

Trends & charts

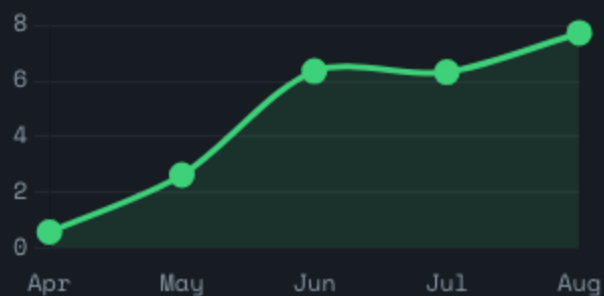
The shape of the story: a step back in volume after four months of growth, but engagement still climbing.

Conversions per month



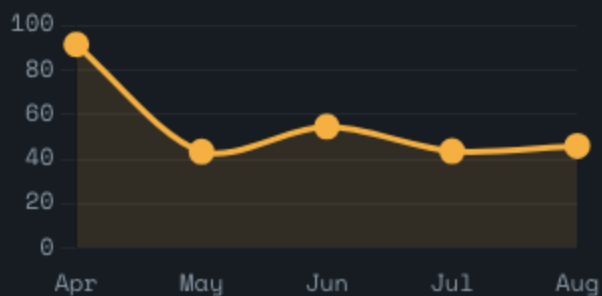
17 → 25 → 28 → 51 → 41. The first decline in the account's history, on 15% less spend.

Click-through rate (%)



A new high at 7.73% — more than 13× April, and up again on July.

Cost per conversion (\$)



\$45.91 — up \$2.39 on July, but still half of April's \$91.41.

Keywords doing the heavy lifting 🏆

The same signal as last month, and it strengthened: **local town names win**. Terms naming a specific suburb or the Yarra Valley delivered leads at well under the cost of broad metro terms — and this month they carried the larger share of the leads.

Local town & Yarra Valley terms

\$37.13

per lead · 24 leads from \$891 spend

Broad "melbourne / near me" terms

\$58.30

per lead · 17 leads from \$991 spend

Local terms took **47% of the spend and returned 59% of the leads**. In July local terms were only about a third of spend, so the balance has shifted the right way. Both halves did get dearer than July, which is consistent with the rising click costs across the account.

KEYWORD	MATCH	QS	CONV	COST	COST / LEAD	CTR
yarra valley towing ★	Broad	5	10.5	\$239.66	\$22.83	17.1%
car towing service near me	Broad	5	9.0	\$391.50	\$43.50	6.4%
towing service melbourne △	Broad	7	7.0	\$501.17	\$71.60	3.6%
pakenham towing	Broad	5	4.0	\$186.69	\$46.67	25.5%
tow truck lilydale ★	Exact	7	3.0	\$74.35	\$24.78	21.4%
tow truck pakenham	Exact	7	2.0	\$100.02	\$50.01	25.0%

KEYWORD	MATCH	QS	CONV	COST	COST / LEAD	CTR
yarra valley towing (new campaign)	Broad	—	2.0	\$65.72	\$32.86	25.0%
towing yarra glen ★	Exact	—	1.5	\$21.48	\$14.32	12.5%
tow truck berwick	Exact	8	1.0	\$26.77	\$26.77	22.2%
tow truck near me △	Exact	3	1.0	\$60.91	\$60.91	7.8%
towing pakenham	Exact	7	0.0	\$90.84	—	27.8%
towing bayswater	Exact	5	0.0	\$40.85	—	50.0%
tow trucks near me △	Exact	5	0.0	\$37.51	—	8.3%
towing healesville	Exact	5	0.0	\$24.14	—	60.0%
towing berwick	Exact	7	0.0	\$20.52	—	11.1%



"yarra valley towing" carried the month

Across both campaigns it produced 12.5 of the month's 41 leads at \$24.43 each, from 16% of the spend. It is comfortably the most efficient lead source in the account.



A dedicated Yarra Valley campaign went live on 22 August

It only ran for the last ten days of the month and already returned 2 leads at \$32.86 each. Small numbers so far, but the early signal is consistent with everything else the Yarra Valley terms have done.



Suburb terms keep pulling extraordinary engagement

Healesville 60% CTR, Bayswater 50%, Pakenham 28%, Berwick 22% — against 3.6% for "towing service melbourne". When someone searches their own town, they click. Healesville, Bayswater and Berwick didn't convert this month, but they did it on very small click volumes.



"towing service melbourne" is the most expensive habit in the account

It took \$501 — a quarter of the entire month's budget — and returned 7 leads at \$71.60 each, at a 3.6% click-through rate. Every local term in the table beats it. That budget would go considerably further pointed at towns.



Quality Score on "tow truck near me" slipped to 3

Down from 4 in July, which means Google is charging more per click for the same position. The good news is the rest of the account moved the other way — "tow trucks near me" recovered from 1 to 5 and "towing service melbourne" from 5 to 7.

The wins 🏆



Best click-through rate and best conversion rate on record

CTR 7.73% and conversion rate 34.5%, both up on July. More than one in three clicks now becomes an enquiry. The traffic reaching the site is the most qualified it has ever been.



The local strategy took over the account

Local town and Yarra Valley terms produced 59% of the leads from 47% of the spend, at \$37.13 against \$58.30 for broad metro. In July local terms were roughly a third of spend — the mix has moved decisively the right way.



A Yarra Valley campaign is now live

Launched 22 August and converting from its first week. It gives the strongest part of the account its own budget rather than competing with metro terms for the same pool.



Cost per lead held up on much lower spend

Spend fell 15% and cost per lead rose only \$2.39. Efficiency was largely protected through a shrinking month — it is still roughly half what it was in April.

Worth watching



The ads were dark on 7 of the month's 31 days

No impressions at all on Saturday 1st, Sunday 2nd, Saturday 8th, and then every Sunday for the rest of the month (9th, 16th, 23rd, 30th). Towing demand does not stop at the weekend — breakdowns and accidents are arguably *more* likely on a Sunday. This is the single clearest volume opportunity in the account.



Daily budget appears to have been reduced mid-month

Both campaigns now sit at \$50/day; the main campaign was on \$80/day through July. Spend per running day fell from \$96.49 across 3–15 August to \$63.13 across 17–31 August. That single change explains most of the drop in lead volume — the account did not stop working, it was given less to work with. Worth confirming the reduction was intended.



Average cost per click rose again — \$14.70 → \$15.82

A third consecutive monthly increase. Lead quality is absorbing it for now, but it steadily erodes how much a fixed budget can buy.



\$506.87 produced no conversions at all

That is 27% of the month's spend. Much of it sits on local terms that simply had a quiet month and are worth keeping. But roughly

\$161 is clearly blockable

— competitor names (sheen towing bayswater, road angels towing, anytime towing melbourne), off-service queries (tow truck hire, tilt tray hire, car transport melbourne, interstate towing, emergency motorcycle towing) and towns outside the service area (geelong towing services, towing tullamarine).



Conversion value still isn't tracked

Leads are counted but not valued, so we still cannot report revenue or return on ad spend. An average job value is all that's needed to unlock dollar-return reporting. This has now been outstanding for five months and is the one thing holding the reporting back.

Recommended next steps

1

Confirm the budget position — both campaigns are on \$50/day against \$80/day in July. If the reduction wasn't deliberate, restoring it is the fastest route back to July's lead volume.

2

Turn the ads on seven days a week — seven dark days cost a full week of a month that only converts when it's running. Weekend towing demand is real.

3

Add the negative keyword list — competitor names, hire and interstate-transport queries, and out-of-area towns. Recovers roughly \$161/month immediately.

4

Feed the Yarra Valley campaign — it is the cheapest lead source in the account and has had ten days and a small budget. Give it room and add the neighbouring towns.

5

Rebalance away from "towing service melbourne" — a quarter of the budget at \$71.60 a lead, when local terms return leads at \$37.13.

6

Set a conversion value — so next month's report can show actual return, not just lead count.

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